



Individual Instructor Report Fall 2023 Version B for STA 301 - INTRODUCTION TO DATA SCIENCE (05360) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Fall 2023**

Courses Audience: **50**

Responses Received: **25**

Response Ratio: **50.0%**

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

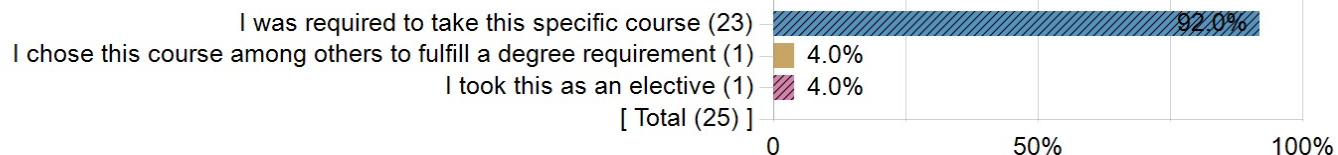
The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

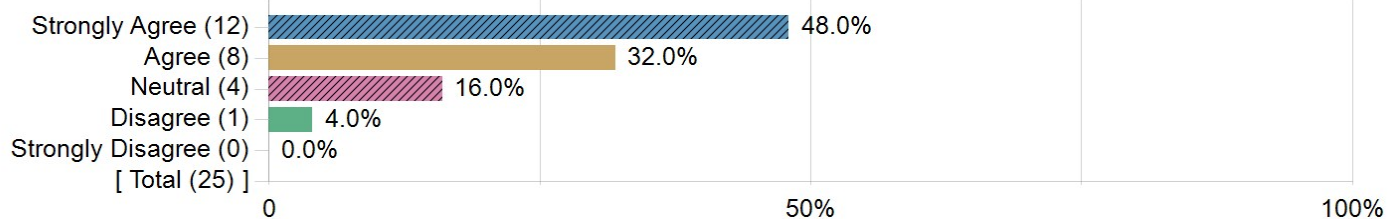
Creation Date: **Sunday, January 21, 2024**

Course Questions

Why did you take this course?



During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.



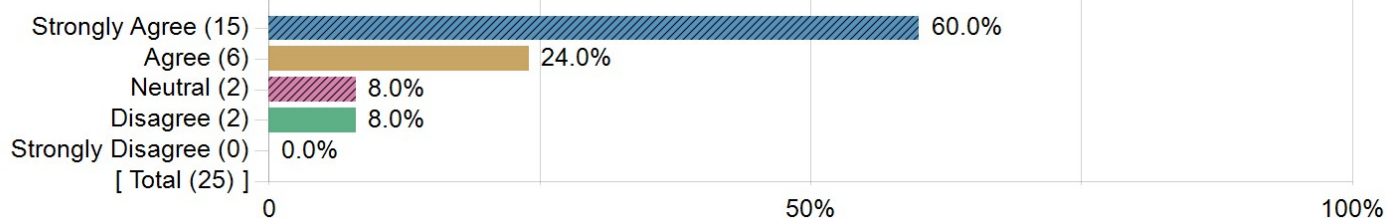
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.24

The course was well organized.



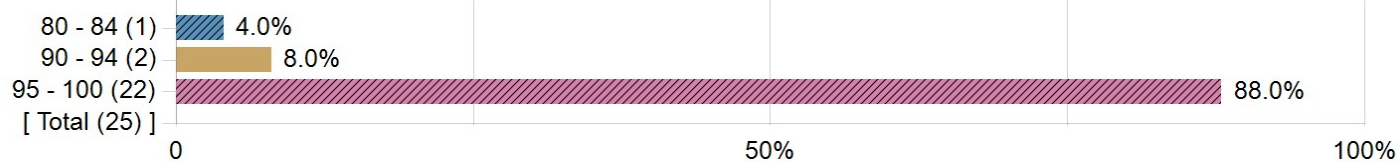
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.36

Overall, approximately what percentage of the course meetings did you attend or complete (online, in person, or asynchronously)?



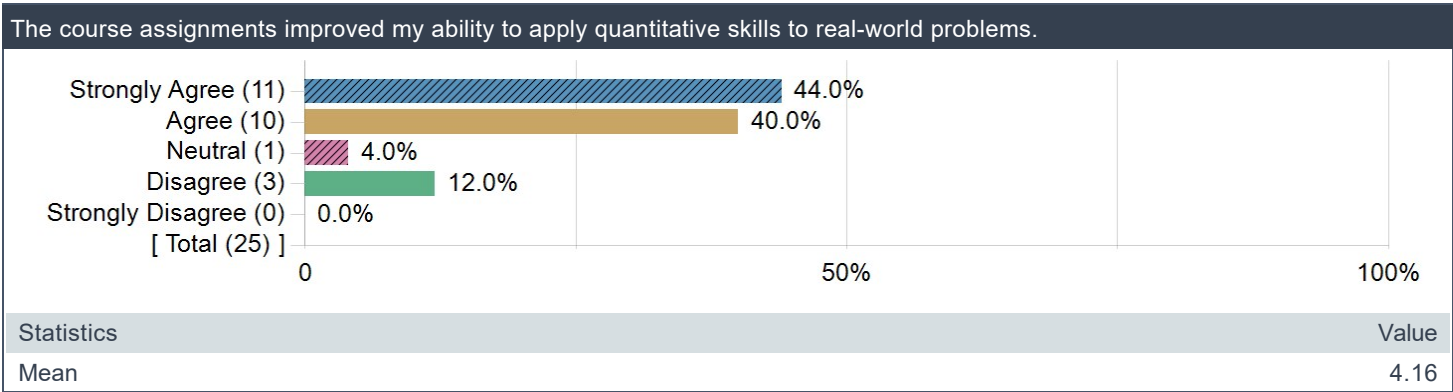
Statistics

Value

Mean

97.36

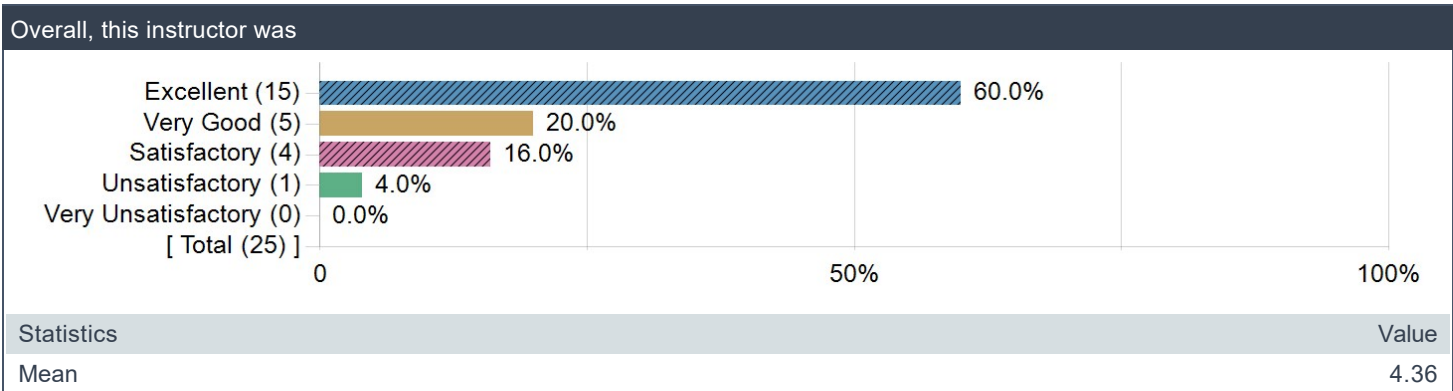
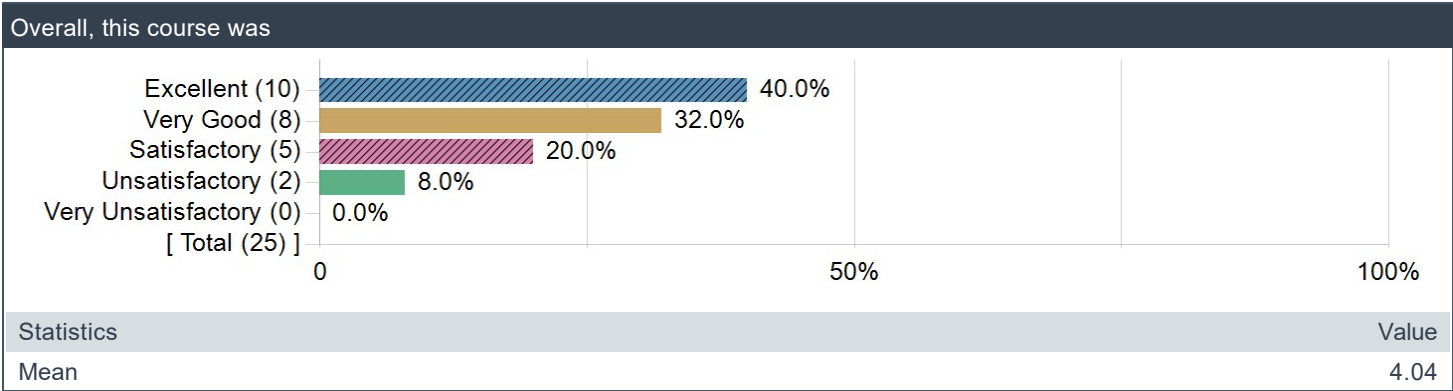
The course assignments improved my ability to apply quantitative skills to real-world problems. (Flag Question)



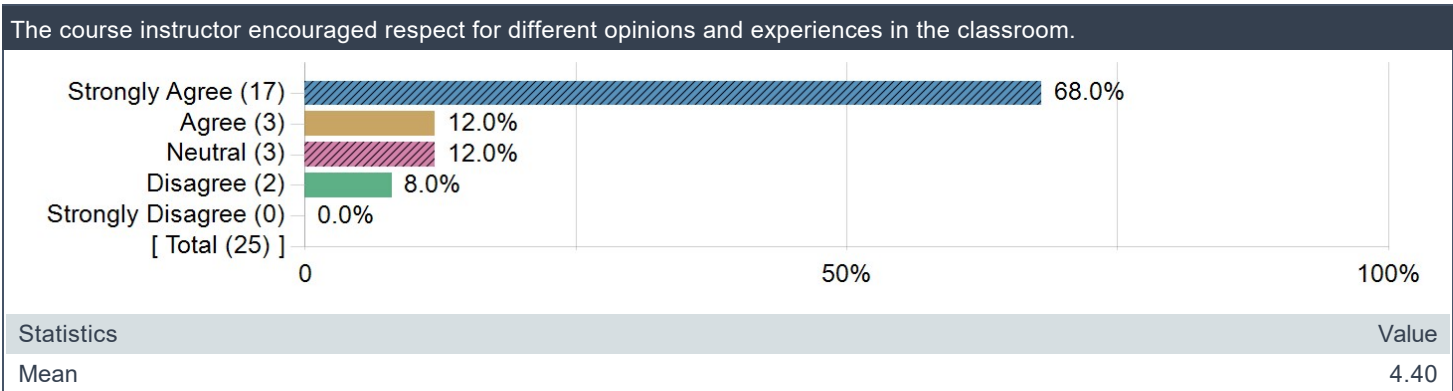
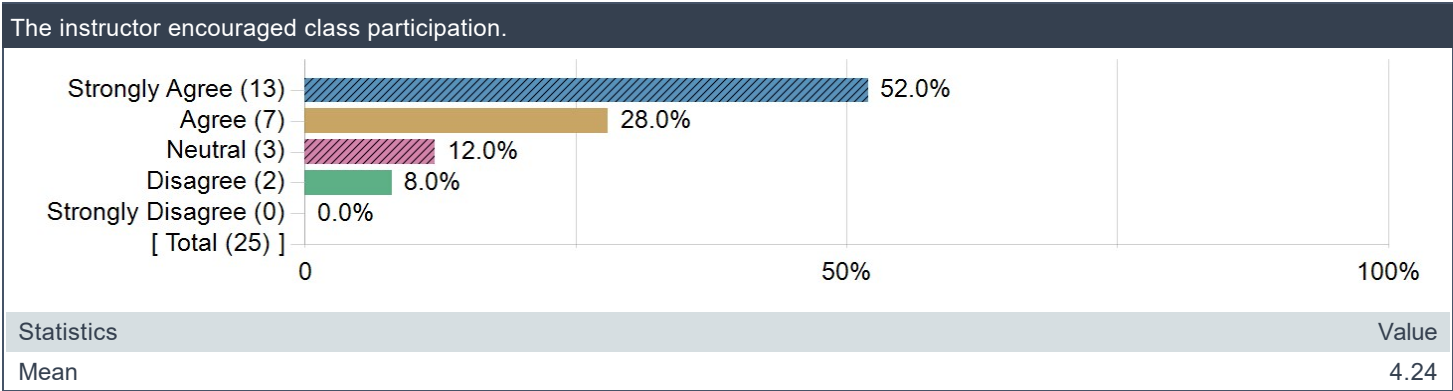
Instructor Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	64.0%	20.0%	12.0%	4.0%	0.0%	25	4.44
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	64.0%	28.0%	8.0%	0.0%	0.0%	25	4.56
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	40.0%	48.0%	4.0%	8.0%	0.0%	25	4.20
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	36.0%	36.0%	20.0%	4.0%	4.0%	25	3.96
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	56.0%	24.0%	8.0%	12.0%	0.0%	25	4.24

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
Reading the textbooks and attending the lectures as well as doing the kc checks where the most helpful because it allowed me to have an idea of what we were learning that week in class then the examples during the class allowed me to apply what I read from the textbook and the Kc check provided practice.
Expertise and explaining capacity of the professor
Using R was definitely beneficial in understanding topics and applying to the real world. Even during this semester, I've used R for other classes, thus saving me a lot of time.
The R sessions were helpful. The professor was good at answering questions after class. Very approachable.
content for each class is clearly written out in advance
Examples and walking through questions
R–studio practice during class
Professor Bolfarine is really nice and flexible. He is also a great teacher.
Definitely the Knowledge Checks, they helped me see how questions were going to be asked over the topics that we learned, deepening my understanding after each lesson.
Class
readings and practice exams
In class R code
The most effective aspects were the textbook and the slides.
In class practice
Knowledge checks
The topics

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
Nothing
I found the professor's grammar to be quite a challenge at times. His grammar, by far, was not bad at all; however, with the questions in Statistics being able to drastically change based on specificity, it became a bit difficult to know what some questions were asking, or what some topics exactly meant. However, I have family from Brazil learning English from Portuguese, so the challenge was much easier in my case, as I see Portuguese → English grammar mistakes often.
The class as a whole was difficult for me being new to coding. No advice for improvement, it's a personal issue. I appreciated the unlimited attempts for KCs.
practice tests were not realistic enough to the real thing; I think students should get access to old exams to get a more accurate representation of what they can expect
Sometimes explanations were unclear or it was unclear what the important parts of the lecture were
Better explanations when going through conceptual aspects of the course
It was challenging having to sit through most concepts that I already knew from AP Stats in high school :(
Homeworks
Content Heavy, I would suggest future students to keep up with the work
Some concepts, challenging for students who have never seen the content, more practice problems with R
The homework assignments were challenging and the KC checks. To help future students is ask questions and study material.
Tests
Homeworks
The homework